



THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIKI

Aranya Kanda

A Children's Illustrated Storybook · 21 Pages

BOOK THREE · THE BOOK OF THE FOREST

An original simplified retelling for children,
with detailed AI illustration prompts.

Based on the translation by Hari Prasad Shastri.

How to Use This Book

Each page has two parts:

- **Story Text for Kids** — 2–4 simple, magical sentences to read aloud.
- **AI Image Prompt** — a richly detailed prompt written for a **polished digital children's-book illustration** look, kept visually consistent from page to page, **full-bleed with no borders**.

This book continues directly from the Bala Kanda storybook. For best results, paste the **Master Style Block** (below) together with each page's prompt, or simply use each prompt as-is — the art-style and character notes are already woven into every one.

Master Style Block (for visual consistency)

Medium & style: Richly detailed **digital children's-storybook illustration**, in the style of a modern Illustrated Ramayana for Children cover — **semi-realistic yet softly stylized** characters with expressive friendly faces, large warm eyes and smooth skin; polished **digital painting** with gentle **cel-shading**, soft airbrushed gradients and crisp clean highlights; finely detailed costumes, fabrics and ornaments; **lush painterly backgrounds** with atmospheric depth and soft focus.

Lighting: warm **cinematic** directional light with a gentle glowing rim-light and soft ambient glow.

Colour: vibrant, saturated, harmonious — forest greens, saffron, marigold gold, turquoise, rose-magenta and deep indigo.

Skin tones: Only **Rama** (and, where they appear, divine forms of **Vishnu** and **Shiva**) has gentle **blue/teal skin**; **every other character has a natural human skin tone** — warm golden-brown, fair or tawny — and is **never blue**. Vanaras (monkey-people) keep natural fur colours.

Costume: strictly **ancient, traditional Indian attire** — dhotis, angavastrams, draped saris, mukut crowns and traditional gold jewelry, bark-cloth and deerskin for forest-exiles, classical robes and armour — with **absolutely no modern clothing, fabrics, footwear or accessories**.

Composition: dynamic, **full-bleed, edge-to-edge, absolutely no border and no frame**. Aspect ratio 4:3 (use portrait 3:4 for a cover).

Character Reference Sheet (keep consistent on every page)

(In the Aranya Kanda the three live as forest-exiles, so they wear simple ascetic garments — bark-cloth and saffron — with hair in ascetic top-knots, yet keep their noble bearing and recognisable features.)

- **Rama** — gentle prince, soft **blue/teal skin**, large kind eyes, calm brave half-smile; simple saffron/bark-cloth wrap, dark hair in an ascetic top-knot, golden quiver and great bow. Serene, radiating quiet strength.
- **Sita** — radiant golden-brown complexion, soft expressive eyes, jasmine flowers in a long dark braid; graceful simple ochre-and-saffron forest sari, minimal delicate gold jewelry. Gentle and devoted.
- **Lakshmana** — fair golden-brown skin, alert and protective; saffron bark-cloth, bow always ready; ever at Rama's side.
- **Ravana** — mighty **ten-headed demon-king of Lanka**, dark complexion, ten crowned heads (one dominant, others fanned behind), many powerful arms, ornate golden armour and jewels, deep red-and-gold robes, fierce eyes; imposing and regal but **never gory** — kid-friendly menace.
- **Jatayu** — majestic aged **giant eagle-king**, russet-and-gold plumage, broad sweeping wings, wise kind eyes, noble loyal bearing.

- **Shurpanakha** — Ravana's shape-shifting demoness sister; wild dark hair, sharp features, ragged crimson garments; menacing yet a touch comical, gentle and not frightening.
- **Golden Deer (Maricha in disguise)** — an enchanting magical fawn, shimmering golden coat with silver spots and jeweled antlers, big innocent eyes, a faint uncanny sparkle.
- **Sages (Agastya, Sharabhanga, Sutikshna)** — serene powerful ascetics, long white beards, soft glowing auras, saffron robes, *rudraksha* beads.
- **Shabari** — a frail, loving old woman ascetic, white hair, simple bark robes, a joyful wrinkled face full of devotion.

Page 1: Into the Great Forest

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Deep in the vast Dandaka Forest, Rama, Sita, and Lakshmana walked among ancient trees and singing birds. The gentle sages who lived there were overjoyed to see them and offered fruit, flowers, and blessings. "Welcome, noble prince," they said, "your kindness lights up our woods."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A lush, sun-dappled clearing deep in the **Dandaka Forest** at warm morning light. **Rama** (soft blue skin, ascetic top-knot, simple saffron forest wrap, great bow on his back), gentle **Sita** (golden-brown, jasmine in her braid, ochre forest sari) and watchful **Lakshmana** are warmly welcomed by a group of serene elderly **sages** in saffron robes who offer baskets of fruit and lotus blooms with joyful, blessing gestures. Surroundings: towering ancient trees with hanging vines, thatched hermitage huts, deer and peacocks, butterflies, soft shafts of golden light through the canopy, a sparkling brook. Emotions: warmth, reverence, peaceful welcome. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed foliage and robes, lush atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (forest-green-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 2: The Demon Viradha

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Suddenly a huge, fearsome demon named Viradha leaped out and snatched up Sita! Brave Rama and Lakshmana sprang into action and defeated him at once. To everyone's surprise, the demon turned into a shining spirit — for their courage had freed him from an old curse.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dramatic forest confrontation in dappled greenish light. The towering, wild **demon Viradha** — large, shaggy, stylized and kid-friendly (not gory) — has scooped up frightened **Sita** in one arm; **Rama** and **Lakshmana** rush forward fiercely with drawn bows and bright determined faces. Above, a soft hint of a glowing celestial spirit begins to rise from the demon in a swirl of golden light, showing his curse breaking. Surroundings: deep tangled forest, gnarled trees, scattered leaves, dramatic shafts of light. Emotions: alarm, courage, swift heroism, wondrous release. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized heroes and a non-scary stylized demon, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dynamic soft gradients, glowing transformation effect, atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic light with warm rim-glow on the brothers; rich saturated colours (deep-green-indigo-saffron). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 3: Blessings of the Holy Sages

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

As they journeyed on, they met wise old sages like Sharabhanga and Sutikshna, who had waited their whole lives just to see Rama. Filled with peace, the great sage Sharabhanga rose into the heavens in a glow of light. The forest hermits welcomed Rama like a long-lost son.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene hermitage glade bathed in soft golden-green light. The radiant elderly sage **Sharabhanga**, glowing with peace and a gentle smile, begins to ascend gracefully upward on a soft beam of celestial light toward a luminous heaven, palms joined; **Rama**, **Sita** and **Lakshmana** watch with reverent, moved expressions, hands folded. Nearby, other kindly sages including **Sutikshna** bow in welcome. Surroundings: a tranquil hermitage with a sacred fire, blossoming trees, gentle deer, lotus pond, soft light-rays and drifting petals. Emotions: devotion, serenity, sacred awe. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft gradients, detailed robes and hermitage, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with radiant rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-gold-cream). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 4: A Promise to Protect

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The gentle hermits came to Rama with worried hearts. "Wicked demons trouble our prayers and harm the innocent," they said. Rama lifted his bow and made a solemn promise: "Do not fear. I will protect all who are good and kind." Protecting others, he knew, was his sacred duty.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A heartfelt gathering at a forest hermitage in warm afternoon light. A group of anxious, gentle **sages** with folded hands stand before **Rama**, who stands tall and noble, one hand raised in a solemn vow and the other holding his great bow, his face calm, strong and reassuring. **Sita** and **Lakshmana** stand supportively at his side. Surroundings: thatched huts, a smoking sacred-fire altar, towering trees, soft sunbeams, watchful deer. Emotions: worry turning to relief, solemn resolve, protective strength. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed robes and bow, lush atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 5: Sita's Gentle Wisdom

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

That night, kind Sita spoke softly to Rama. "Be brave, my love, but never fight unless you truly must — for gentleness is also a great strength." Rama smiled and thanked her for her wise and loving words. Yet he reminded her of his promise to keep the good people safe.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender, intimate evening scene outside their forest dwelling under a deep starry sky. Gentle **Sita** (golden-brown, jasmine in her braid, ochre sari) speaks softly with a caring, thoughtful expression, one hand resting on **Rama's** arm; **Rama** (soft blue

skin, ascetic top-knot) listens with a warm, loving, attentive smile. A small glowing campfire lights their faces. Surroundings: a cosy leaf-and-bamboo hut, fireflies, towering moonlit trees, a crescent moon, soft mist. Emotions: tenderness, wisdom, mutual love and respect. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing firelight gradients, detailed fabrics, intimate atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic night lighting with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (rose-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 6: The Gifts of Sage Agastya

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Travelling deeper, they reached the hermitage of the mighty sage Agastya. Pleased with Rama's goodness, he gave him a magnificent divine bow, an endless quiver of arrows, and a gleaming sword. "These were made by the gods," said Agastya, "to help you protect what is right."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand, glowing hermitage of the great sage **Agastya** in warm sacred light. The serene, powerful sage — long white beard, radiant aura, saffron robes — presents to kneeling **Rama** a magnificent shining **divine bow**, a golden **quiver of arrows** and a gleaming **sword**, all softly glowing with celestial light. **Rama** receives them with humble folded hands and a reverent face; **Sita** and **Lakshmana** watch in awe. Surroundings: an ornate forest ashram, sacred fire, lotus ponds, blossoming trees, drifting petals, beams of golden light. Emotions: humility, gratitude, sacred empowerment. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous glowing soft gradients on the divine weapons, detailed robes and ornaments, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with radiant rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-violet-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 7: Jatayu, the Noble Eagle-King

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

On the path they met a wonderful giant eagle named Jatayu, who had been a dear friend of Rama's father, King Dasaratha. "I will watch over you like family," the noble bird promised. Rama was glad to have such a brave and loyal guardian in the wild forest.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A majestic meeting in a sunlit forest glade. The magnificent aged **eagle-king Jatayu** — enormous, with glorious russet-and-gold plumage, broad outspread wings and wise, kind eyes — bows his great head respectfully toward **Rama**, **Sita** and **Lakshmana**, who gaze up at him with warm wonder and gratitude, Rama reaching out a friendly hand. Surroundings: a towering ancient tree perch, golden afternoon light, drifting feathers and leaves, distant misty hills, fluttering forest birds. Emotions: warmth, trust, noble friendship, wonder. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters and a grand detailed eagle, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, finely detailed feathers, lush atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (amber-green-russet-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 8: A Happy Home in Panchavati

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

At last they reached a beautiful place called Panchavati, beside the sparkling Godavari River. Lakshmana built a cosy little hut of leaves and bamboo, and they lived simply and happily among the deer and flowers. For a while, the forest felt like a peaceful, magical home.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

An idyllic, peaceful forest home at **Panchavati** beside the shining **Godavari River** in golden light. A charming little leaf-and-bamboo hut sits among flowering trees; **Lakshmana** finishes tying the thatched roof, **Sita** lovingly waters blossoming plants and feeds gentle spotted deer, and **Rama** sits content with his bow nearby, all with happy, serene faces. Surroundings: the glittering river, lotus blooms, peacocks, butterflies, soft mist on distant green hills, dappled sunbeams. Emotions: contentment, simple joy, harmony with nature. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed hut and foliage, lush atmospheric riverside depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border**, **no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 9: The Demoness in the Woods

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

One day a demoness named Shurpanakha, the sister of the demon-king Ravana, spied Rama and was dazzled by him. Using her magic, she took the shape of a pretty lady and tried to charm him away. But Rama gently and truthfully told her that his heart belonged only to Sita.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tense, curious forest encounter in dappled light. The demoness **Shurpanakha** — having magically taken a deceptively pretty form, though a hint of her wild demonic nature shows in her sharp eyes and shadow — approaches **Rama** with a flattering, scheming smile; **Rama** stands calm, polite and honest, one hand raised in a gentle, truthful refusal, glancing warmly toward **Sita** nearby. **Lakshmana** watches warily. Surroundings: the leafy hermitage, flowering vines, the hut behind, soft greenish light, watchful birds. Emotions: vanity and scheming versus calm honesty and devotion. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, subtle uncanny aura on the demoness, lush atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (green-magenta-saffron). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border**, **no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 10: Lakshmana Drives Her Away

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Angry at being refused, Shurpanakha showed her fierce demon form and lunged toward Sita. Quick as lightning, brave Lakshmana stepped in and drove the demoness away, sending her fleeing into the trees. Shrieking with rage, she raced off to find her brothers.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dynamic, dramatic forest action moment. The demoness **Shurpanakha** has snapped back into her wild rakshasi form —

tangled hair, sharp features, ragged crimson garments (stylized, not gory) — lunging with fury; **Lakshmana** steps boldly in front of **Sita** protectively, sword and arm raised to drive the demoness back as she recoils and turns to flee shrieking into the dark trees. **Rama** moves protectively toward Sita. Surroundings: the hermitage clearing, scattered leaves, dramatic dappled light, startled birds taking flight. Emotions: fury, protective courage, sudden danger. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized heroes and a non-gory stylized demoness, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dynamic soft gradients, motion energy, atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic light with warm rim-glow on the heroes; rich saturated colours (dusky-green-crimson-indigo). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 11: An Army of Demons

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Shurpanakha ran to her brother Khara, who was furious and sent a huge army of fourteen thousand demons to attack Rama. Dark clouds gathered and the earth trembled as they marched through the forest. But Rama stood tall and unafraid, ready to protect Sita and Lakshmana.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

An epic, dramatic forest scene beneath a darkening sky. A vast **army of demon-warriors (Titans)** with crude weapons, banners and fierce stylized faces (kid-friendly, not gory) advances through the trees amid swirling dark clouds and ominous portents. Alone before them stands **Rama** — calm, noble and utterly fearless, his great divine bow drawn, a soft heroic glow about him — having placed **Sita** and **Lakshmana** safely in a sheltered cave behind. Surroundings: storm-shadowed forest, lightning, wind-tossed trees, dust and dramatic light. Emotions: looming threat, fearless courage, heroic resolve. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized hero and a stylized demon horde, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dramatic moody gradients, atmospheric stormy depth with soft focus, cinematic lighting with a warm rim-glow on Rama; rich saturated colours (storm-grey-green-saffron). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 12: Rama's Great Victory

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

With astonishing speed and skill, Rama sent forth a storm of shining arrows. One by one the demons were defeated, until even their mighty leaders Khara, Dushana, and Trishiras were overcome. The forest grew quiet and safe again, and the grateful sages rejoiced.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A triumphant, light-filled action climax. **Rama** stands heroically at the center, his divine bow blazing as a dazzling fan of golden arrows streaks outward, glowing energy swirling around him; the demon army scatters and dissolves into harmless wisps of shadow and light (no gore). Above, the dark clouds part to reveal warm golden sky; gods and sages peek from soft glowing clouds, raising hands in joyful blessing and showering petals. Surroundings: a clearing forest battlefield turning peaceful, returning sunbeams, drifting feathers and petals. Emotions: awe, triumph, relief, divine justice. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized hero, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous dynamic gradients, glowing arrow-energy, atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic light breaking through storm with strong rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-emerald-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 13: Shurpanakha Stirs Up Ravana

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Shurpanakha flew across the sea to the golden city of Lanka, where her brother Ravana, the ten-headed demon-king, sat upon his throne. Weeping with anger, she told him of Rama's power and of Sita's great beauty. A wicked, jealous plan began to form in Ravana's many heads.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand, dramatic throne hall in the golden city of **Lanka**, lit with torch-fire and deep crimson shadows. The mighty **Ravana** — ten crowned heads (one dominant, others fanned behind), many arms, dark complexion, ornate golden armour and red-gold robes, fierce brooding eyes — looms upon a towering jeweled throne, listening as the wild demoness **Shurpanakha** kneels before him, gesturing dramatically and weeping with rage as she describes Rama and Sita. Surroundings: massive carved pillars, demon guards, flickering torches, opulent gold, an ominous mood. Emotions: rage, scheming, dawning wicked desire. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, imposing but non-gory demon king, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dramatic torchlit gradients, ornate detailed throne and armour, atmospheric depth with soft focus, moody cinematic lighting with fiery rim-glow; rich saturated colours (crimson-gold-indigo). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 14: The Magical Golden Deer

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Ravana flew to a clever demon named Maricha and ordered him to use magic. "Become a beautiful golden deer," he commanded, "and lure Rama away from Sita." Though Maricha was frightened and warned against it, he was forced to obey the cruel king's wicked plan.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tense, magical transformation scene on a windswept seaside cliff at dusk. The towering ten-headed **Ravana** commands sternly with a pointing arm, his red aura glowing; before him, the demon **Maricha** is mid-transformation — his form swirling with shimmering golden magic-light as he becomes an exquisite **golden deer** with silver spots and jeweled antlers, a worried, reluctant look in its big eyes. Surroundings: dramatic cliffs, crashing moonlit waves, swirling magical sparkles, deep twilight sky. Emotions: cruel command, fear, reluctant obedience, dark enchantment. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous magical gradients and transformation glow, detailed ornaments, atmospheric seaside depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic twilight lighting with rim-glow; rich saturated colours (golden-amber-violet). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 15: Sita and the Golden Fawn

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The dazzling golden deer pranced into the garden at Panchavati, sparkling like sunshine. Sita had never seen anything so lovely and longed to keep it. "Oh Rama," she begged, "please catch that beautiful deer for me!"

AI IMAGE PROMPT

An enchanting, sunlit forest-garden scene at Panchavati. A magnificent **golden deer** with a shimmering jewel-spotted coat and

gleaming antlers prances gracefully among the flowers, glowing with magical light; **Sita** (golden-brown, jasmine in her braid, ochre sari) gazes at it with delighted, longing wonder, hands clasped, reaching toward it; **Rama** stands nearby, fond but faintly thoughtful, while **Lakshmana** watches with a flicker of suspicion. Surroundings: blossoming hermitage garden, the leaf hut, butterflies, sparkling light, the river beyond. Emotions: wonder, longing, innocent delight, a hint of unease. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters and a luminous magical deer, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed garden and fabrics, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (gold-emerald-rose). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 16: The Deer's Trick

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

To make Sita happy, Rama set off after the magical deer, asking Lakshmana to guard her. The deer led him far, far away before Rama discovered it was really the demon Maricha. As it fell, the cunning demon cried out in Rama's own voice, "Help! Sita! Lakshmana!"

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dramatic deep-forest chase scene in fading afternoon light. **Rama** (soft blue skin, bark-cloth, great bow) stands amid tall trees having just shot a glowing arrow; the **golden deer** is collapsing far from home, its magical golden disguise dissolving to reveal a hint of the demon **Maricha** beneath, its mouth open in a deceitful cry. Faint wavy sound-lines and a small ghostly echo-image of Rama's face show the demon mimicking Rama's voice. Surroundings: dense shadowy forest, twisting trees, scattered leaves, dusky golden light, a sense of distance and trickery. Emotions: dawning alarm, cunning deceit, danger. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized hero, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft dramatic gradients, glowing magic-dissolve effect, atmospheric deep-forest depth with soft focus, moody cinematic light with warm rim-glow on Rama; rich saturated colours (green-saffron-dusk). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 17: Sita Sends Lakshmana

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Hearing the cry, Sita grew frightened and begged Lakshmana to run and help his brother. Lakshmana knew Rama was far too strong to be in danger, but Sita's worry was so great that at last he went. With a heavy heart, he hurried off to find Rama, leaving Sita alone.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

An emotional, tense moment outside the leaf hut at Panchavati in anxious golden-grey light. **Sita** (worried, pleading face, hands pressed together) urges a reluctant **Lakshmana** to go; he stands torn, looking back over his shoulder with deep concern and loyalty as he steps toward the dark forest, bow in hand. The forest beyond looks suddenly shadowed and uneasy. Surroundings: the cosy hut, wilting light, gathering shadows among the trees, a few uneasy birds, the river dull behind. Emotions: fear, worry, divided loyalty, foreboding. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft moody gradients, detailed fabrics and hut, atmospheric depth with soft focus, tense cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; rich saturated colours (amber-green-anxious-grey). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 18: Ravana Takes Sita Away

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Now that Sita was alone, Ravana came disguised as a gentle holy man asking for food. The kind-hearted Sita welcomed him — but suddenly he revealed his ten terrible heads and carried her up into his flying chariot! As they soared away, clever Sita dropped her jewels below, hoping they would help Rama find her.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dramatic, sweeping abduction scene over the treetops at stormy dusk. The mighty **Ravana**, his disguise as a humble saffron-robed holy man falling away to reveal his ten crowned heads and many arms, lifts **Sita** into his ornate flying golden chariot pulled by magical demon-steeds, rising into a turbulent sky. Brave **Sita** twists away, frightened but defiant, **dropping a trail of sparkling golden jewels and flowers** down toward the green forest far below as a secret clue. Surroundings: swirling dark clouds, the tiny hut and forest beneath, dramatic shafts of fading light, scattering birds. Emotions: shock, fear, courage, desperate cleverness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, imposing non-gory demon king, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dramatic moody gradients, ornate detailed chariot, sweeping aerial atmospheric depth with soft focus, cinematic stormy light with rim-glow; rich saturated colours (dark-crimson-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 19: Brave Jatayu Fights

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The noble eagle Jatayu heard Sita's cries and bravely flew to stop Ravana. Though old, he fought the demon-king with all his might to save her. Sadly, the mighty Ravana wounded the gallant bird, and Jatayu fell gently to the earth — a true and loyal hero.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A heroic, poignant aerial battle in a dramatic dusk sky. The magnificent aged eagle-king **Jatayu**, wings spread wide and eyes blazing with noble courage, clashes bravely against **Ravana's** flying chariot, shielding the frightened **Sita** who reaches toward him hopefully. The ten-headed demon-king fights back fiercely. Below, the great wounded bird is shown beginning to glide gently downward toward the green forest, dignified and brave even in defeat (gentle, not gory). Surroundings: turbulent golden-grey clouds, scattered feathers, the distant forest, dramatic light beams. Emotions: bravery, sacrifice, loyalty, sorrow, admiration. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters and a grand detailed eagle, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, dramatic soft gradients, dynamic motion, atmospheric sky depth with soft focus, cinematic dusk lighting with warm rim-glow on Jatayu; rich saturated colours (storm-grey-russet-crimson-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 20: A Friend's Last Words

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

When Rama and Lakshmana returned, their hearts broke to find the hut empty and Sita gone. Searching in sorrow, they found brave Jatayu, who used his last breath to tell them, "Ravana flew south... with Sita." Rama wept for his loyal friend and gently helped him on his final journey, then vowed to find Sita.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender, emotional forest scene in soft, sorrowful golden light. **Rama** (grief on his gentle face, tears shining) and **Lakshmana** kneel beside the great fallen eagle **Jatayu**, who lifts his noble head weakly to speak his last loyal words, one wing pointing **southward**; Rama cradles the brave bird's head with deep compassion and gratitude. A soft glow suggests Jatayu's spirit gently rising. Surroundings: the quiet forest, the empty leaf hut behind, scattered dropped flowers, dim shafts of light, a hushed, reverent mood. Emotions: grief, gratitude, loyalty, tender farewell, determined hope. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with deeply expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft sorrowful gradients, detailed feathers and fabrics, atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, gentle cinematic light with soft rim-glow; rich saturated colours (sombre-indigo-amber-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 21: Shabari's Devotion and a New Hope

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

As they searched on, Rama and Lakshmana met Shabari, a loving old woman who had waited her whole life just to serve Rama, offering him sweet berries with all her heart. Blessing her pure devotion, Rama walked on toward the shining Lake Pampa. There, new friends — the monkey-king Sugriva and his people — were waiting to help him rescue Sita, and so the great adventure continued.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A warm, hopeful closing scene at the edge of a glittering forest lake (**Lake Pampa**) in golden morning light. The frail, joyful old ascetic **Shabari** — white hair, simple bark robes, a radiant loving face — lovingly offers a small basket of berries to **Rama**, who receives them with a tender, grateful smile and a hand raised in blessing; **Lakshmana** stands warmly nearby. Beyond, the beautiful sun-dappled lake stretches toward distant green hills, lotus blooms, swans and birds, soft light promising new friends and new hope. Emotions: pure devotion, gratitude, warmth, hope, the promise of more adventures. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, luminous soft gradients, detailed robes and lakeside foliage, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic morning light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (warm-rose-green-gold-dawn). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

The End of Aranya Kanda

*This completes Book Three of the Ramayana — the **Aranya Kanda** ("The Forest") — retold in 21 chronological pages, faithfully preserving its core events and moral depth: life as forest-exiles among the sages, the freeing of Viradha, the blessings of Sharabhanga, Sutikshna and Agastya, the divine weapons, the friendship of noble Jatayu, the happy home at Panchavati, the episode of Shurpanakha, the defeat of Khara's army, the trick of the golden deer, the abduction of Sita by Ravana, Jatayu's brave sacrifice, and the devotion of Shabari — woven throughout with gentle lessons of **duty, courage, honesty, loyalty, devotion, and the truth that greed and cruelty always lead to ruin.***

Tips for consistent illustrations:

1. Generate **Page 1 first**, then reuse its renderings of Rama, Sita and Lakshmana (in forest-exile dress) as a style/character reference for later pages; do the same for **Ravana** (Page 13) and **Jatayu** (Page 7).
2. Keep the **Master Style Block** and **Character Reference Sheet** pasted at the top of every prompt.

3. Use the same **aspect ratio (4:3)** and the "**digital children's-book illustration ... full-bleed, no border, no frame**" keywords on every page so this book matches the Bala Kanda volume.
4. The Aranya Kanda is more dramatic than the Bala Kanda — keep demons and battles **stylized and gentle (never gory)**, and lean on warm light and hopeful expressions so it stays kid-friendly.